THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES
CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS X — ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184) · PRACTICE PAPER · SET 04

Session 2026-27 · Mid-Term Pattern

Class: X	Subject: English Language and Literature	Time: 3 Hours	Max. Marks: 80

General Instructions:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections — Section A: Reading Skills; Section B: Grammar and Writing Skills; Section C: Literature Textbook.
3. Attempt questions based on the specific instructions given for each part.

SECTION A — READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

1. When India's first satellite, Aryabhata, was carried into orbit in 1975 aboard a foreign rocket, few people imagined that the country would one day launch dozens of satellites in a single mission. Yet India's space programme has travelled a remarkable distance since those modest beginnings. Today the Indian Space Research Organisation, ISRO, builds its own rockets, sends probes to the Moon and Mars, and earns respect for doing so at a fraction of the cost spent by other nations.

2. The programme was never meant merely to win prestige. From its early days, its leaders insisted that space science must serve ordinary people. Satellites now provide weather warnings that help fishermen return safely before a cyclone, maps that guide farmers on soil and water, and communication links to remote villages and hill stations. During floods and earthquakes, images from space help rescue teams to decide where to reach first. Even a small village school can now take lessons through a satellite link, which would have seemed impossible a generation ago. The benefits therefore reach people who may never see a rocket or know the name of a single scientist.

3. Costs have been kept low through careful planning and the reuse of designs. Engineers often modify existing technology rather than start afresh, and many parts are manufactured within the country. The Mars Orbiter Mission of 2014, for example, cost less than the budget of several Hollywood films, and it made India the first Asian nation to reach Martian orbit at the first attempt. Another mission, Chandrayaan-3, landed near the Moon's south pole in 2023, a region that no other country had reached, and brought lasting pride to a whole generation of young Indians.

4. A new chapter has begun with the opening of the sector to private companies. Young start-ups now design small satellites, rocket engines and tools for analysing satellite data. Students in colleges and even schools build tiny satellites that are launched alongside larger ones, giving thousands of young people a chance to take part in real space missions. Many of these young designers say that the best part of the work is learning to solve problems with limited money, a skill that serves them in any career.

5. The road ahead is not free of challenges. Space debris is growing, competition is intense, and every launch demands years of patient work. Nevertheless, a country that once borrowed a rocket now plans missions with astronauts of its own. The story of the programme shows how careful planning and a clear purpose can turn limited resources into great achievements.

Created for academic usage / 426 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why was it surprising that India later launched dozens of satellites in one mission? (Paragraph 1) **1**

II. According to Paragraph 2, satellites help people in all of the following ways EXCEPT **1**

(A) warning fishermen about cyclones
(B) guiding farmers about soil and water
(C) connecting remote villages
(D) supplying electricity to villages

III. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those in the brackets: The programme was meant to serve _____ rather than only win prestige. (ordinary people / foreign nations) (Paragraph 2) **1**

IV. Select the option that is TRUE about the Mars Orbiter Mission, according to Paragraph 3. **1**

(A) It cost more than several films.
(B) It made India the first Asian nation to reach Mars orbit at the first attempt.
(C) It used only foreign parts.
(D) It failed to reach Mars.

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**
Start-up : Small satellite :: Student team : _____

(A) Tiny satellite
(B) Mars mission

VI. How has ISRO managed to keep the cost of its missions low? (Paragraph 3) **2**

VII. What are the main ideas of Paragraph 4 and Paragraph 5? **1**
i. The sector is open to private companies and students.
ii. The programme faces challenges but has shown the power of planning.
iii. Space research should be stopped.
iv. Satellites are of no use.
v. Rockets must be imported.

Option	Main idea of Paragraph 4	Main idea of Paragraph 5
A	iii	iv
B	i	ii
C	ii	v
D	iv	iii

VIII. What can you infer about the future of India's space programme from the last paragraph? (Paragraph 5) **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

1. A survey of 500 shoppers in a city market studied the use of plastic bags. The results were mixed. About 60% of the shoppers (300) said that they carried their own cloth or jute bags, while the other 40% (200) depended on bags given by shopkeepers, often for a few rupees or even free of cost. Among the latter, 70% (140) said that plastic was more convenient, and 30% (60) said they simply forgot to bring a bag.

2. The survey also tested awareness of the local ban on thin plastic bags. In all, 55% of the shoppers (275) knew about the ban. Among those who carried their own bags, 225 (75%) were aware of it, compared with only 50 of the 200 others (25%). Officials concluded that awareness encourages better habits, although some of the shoppers who knew the rule still used plastic by choice, saying that cloth bags were heavy to carry and inconvenient to wash.

3. Shopkeepers suggested that cloth bags should be sold at low cost near the market gate and that customers be offered a small discount for bringing their own. With these steps, they believe, the market could become almost plastic-free within a year. A few customers, however, argued that unless the ban is also enforced at the wholesale level, thin plastic will keep returning to the market in some form or another.

Created for academic usage / 227 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why does the author describe the results as 'mixed'? (Paragraph 1) **1**

II. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from the brackets. Of the 200 plastic users, most said plastic is _____. (convenient / harmful) (Paragraph 1) **1**

III. Select the option that best explains the word 'aware' in Paragraph 2. **1**

(A) Afraid of something
(B) Having knowledge of something
(C) Angry about something
(D) Tired of something

IV. Complete the following. The figures in Paragraph 2 suggest that **1**

(A) the ban is useless.
(B) shoppers who know about the ban tend to carry their own bags.
(C) cloth bags are costly.
(D) shopkeepers dislike the ban.

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**
Discount : Encouragement :: Fine : _____

(A) Deterrent
(B) Reward

VI. Complete the following appropriately. The 60 shoppers who 'forgot to bring a bag' represent ____ % of those who use plastic. (Paragraph 1) **1**

VII. How many shoppers in all knew about the ban, and what percentage is this? (Paragraph 2) **1**

VIII. Why did officials say that some shoppers still used plastic 'by choice'? (Paragraph 2) **1**

IX. Suggest two ways in which shopkeepers believe the market can become plastic-free. Why might these steps work? (Paragraph 3) **2**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR AND WRITING SKILLS — 20 marks

GRAMMAR — 10

3. Complete any ten of the twelve of the following tasks, as directed. **(10 × 1 = 10)**

I. Fill in the blank using the correct form of the word in brackets for a school notice: **1**
The school takes great _____ (proud) in announcing the success of its team.

II. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**
He gave me an advice about my career.

ERROR	CORRECTION

III. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. **1**
If I _____ (know) her address, I would have sent the invitation.

IV. Read the given statement. **1**
The principal said, “The results will be declared next week.”
Report: The principal said that _____.

V. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **1**
The villagers were suffering _____ a severe drought.

(A) from
(B) of
(C) with
(D) by

VI. Report the following. **1**
“Don't be late for the rehearsal,” the director told the actors.
The director told _____.

VII. Complete the sentence by choosing the correct option. **1**

_____ the match, the team celebrated all night.

(A) Having won
(B) To win
(C) Win
(D) Winning to

VIII. The sentence has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**

One of my cousins live in Canada.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	One	Ones
B.	live	lives
C.	cousins	cousin
D.	Canada	a Canada

IX. Report the following question. **1**

“What are you reading these days?” the librarian asked Rohit.

X. Choose the correct option from the brackets. **1**

It is raining heavily; he _____ (can / may) not have reached home yet.

XI. Fill in the blank with the correct option. **1**

I have _____ time to waste; please be quick.

(A) any
(B) no
(C) many
(D) few

XII. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**

She is the taller of all the girls in the class.

ERROR	CORRECTION

4. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. You are Nisha/Nikhil of Class X. A recent examination was marred by loud construction work next to your school. Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner, in about 120 words, requesting that such work be regulated during examination days.

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B. You are Samar/Simran, the Secretary of the Eco Club. Write a letter to the Principal, in about 120 words, seeking permission to hold a tree plantation drive in the school campus, with details of the plan.

5. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. The school Cultural Committee must choose between two compères for the annual function. **Isha:** fluent and confident, with a witty sense of humour, but often unprepared and forgets names. **Rehan:** well prepared and respectful, but speaks softly and becomes nervous before an audience. Analyse the profiles and decide who would be the better compère. (100–120 words)

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B. The table compares two mobile data plans.

Features	Plan X	Plan Y
Monthly cost	₹299	₹499
Data per day	1.5 GB	3 GB
Validity	28 days	56 days
Calls	Unlimited	Unlimited
Extra benefits	None	Streaming subscription

Study the data and write an analytical paragraph in 100–120 words comparing the plans and recommending the better one for a student who uses data mainly for online classes.

SECTION C — LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

> *The Buddha listened to the grieving mother and told her that he could cure her only if she brought him a handful of mustard seeds. But the seeds must come from a house where no one had ever died. She went from door to door, and everywhere she heard the same story of loss.*
>
> (The Sermon at Benares — extract adapted)

I. What did the Buddha ask Kisa Gotami to bring? **1**

(A) Medicine
(B) Mustard seeds
(C) Water
(D) Flowers

II. What condition did he put on the seeds? **1**

III. Complete suitably. Kisa Gotami's search taught her that death is _____. **1**

(A) rare
(B) universal
(C) a punishment
(D) avoidable

IV. How does the Buddha's method help Kisa Gotami accept her loss? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

OR

(b)

> *Lomov arrived in his best clothes to ask for Natalya's hand. Before long, the talk turned to who owned the Oxen Meadows, and voices were raised. Chubukov, her father, took her side, and the suitor's nervous heart began to hurt so much that he almost fainted.*
>
> (The Proposal — extract adapted)

I. What was the cause of the quarrel? **1**

(A) A dog
(B) Oxen Meadows
(C) A wedding date
(D) A loan

II. Why did Lomov come to Chubukov's house? **1**

III. Complete suitably. The scene is mainly _____. **1**

(A) tragic
(B) comic
(C) serious
(D) solemn

IV. How does the extract show that the characters are quarrelsome by nature? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

> *The poet describes a girl who is told by her mother to put away her toys, to tidy her hair, to sit straight and to stop dreaming. Amanda wishes only to be a mermaid in a lonely sea, or to be alone like Robin Redbreast in a tree, where nobody would give her orders.*
>
> (Amanda! — paraphrased)

I. What does Amanda want to become? **1**

(A) A bird
(B) A mermaid
(C) A queen
(D) A teacher

II. Who gives Amanda the commands? **1**

(A) Her friends
(B) Her mother
(C) Her teacher
(D) The poet

III. The poem shows Amanda's _____. **1**

(A) fear of water
(B) longing for freedom
(C) disobedience
(D) ill health

IV. How does the poem show a child's need for freedom? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

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(b)

> *The brave Custard the dragon lay down quietly and cried while everyone else boasted. When the pirate came, however, it was he who leapt up and fought, gobbled the pirate, and then returned to his place, hungry for praise but quite content to be called a coward again.*
>
> (The Tale of Custard the Dragon — paraphrased)

I. How did the others treat Custard? **1**

(A) As a hero
(B) They called him a coward
(C) As a king
(D) As a guest

II. What did Custard do when the pirate came? **1**

III. The poem is mainly _____. **1**

(A) tragic
(B) humorous
(C) serious
(D) mournful

IV. What does the poem suggest about real courage? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions in 40–50 words each. **(4 × 3 = 12)**

I. What was the mistake made by the doctor in 'A Triumph of Surgery'? Why did Tricki improve? (A Triumph of Surgery)

II. How does the pilot's meeting with the black aeroplane show courage? (Two Stories about Flying)

III. Describe Anne Frank's feelings about Mr Dussel. (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

IV. How does the conductor treat Valli when she boards the bus? (Madam Rides the Bus)

V. How does the Tiger in the Zoo contrast with his wild life? (A Tiger in the Zoo)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions in 40–50 words each. (2 × 3 = 6)

I. How does Bholi's father show his love for her in the end? (Bholi)

II. What does the story 'A Question of Trust' teach about misplaced trust? (A Question of Trust)

III. Why was the Book That Saved the Earth a comic tale? Mention two humorous ideas. (The Book That Saved the Earth)

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) Compare how Natalya and Lomov in 'The Proposal' and Mrs Pumphrey and Tricki in 'A Triumph of Surgery' bring out the humour of human behaviour. (The Proposal / A Triumph of Surgery)

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(B) Discuss how 'Amanda!' and 'The Ball Poem' present childhood experiences and what lessons each offers. (Amanda! / The Ball Poem)

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) 'The Sermon at Benares' teaches that grief can be overcome through understanding. Discuss. (The Sermon at Benares)

O R

(B) 'Humour and irony make 'The Proposal' a lively play.' Discuss with examples. (The Proposal)